



आधिकार

ISSN 2231-2552
IMPACT FACTOR 11.211

(विधि, मानवाधिकार, साहित्य, समाज एवं विज्ञान को समर्पित मासिक अन्तर्राष्ट्रीय शोध-पत्रिका)

ADHIKAR

An International Research Refereed Journal Related
to Higher Education for all Subjects

Year 15 Vol. 2 Feb. 2025



Adhikar

प्रधान संपादक

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अधिकार

Year-15 Vol-2 February, 2025 I

(विधि, मानवाधिकार, साहित्य, समाज एवं विज्ञान को समर्पित मासिक अंतर्राष्ट्रीय शोध-पत्रिका)

ADHIKAR An International Refereed and Peer-Reviewed Research
Journal Related to Higher Education for all Subject

प्रधान संपादक
डॉ. मुकेश कुमार मालवीय
(सहायक प्राध्यापक)
विधि-संकाय
काशी हिन्दू विश्वविद्यालय, वाराणसी (उ०प्र०)
संपर्क-08004851126

संपादक एवं समन्वयक
ओमकार प्रसाद मालवीय
राकेश कुमार मालवीय

कार्यकारी संपादक
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एसोशिएट प्राध्यापक विधि-संकाय काशी हिन्दू
विश्वविद्यालय, वाराणसी

संपादकीय
ओमकार प्रसाद मालवीय
(संपादक एवं समन्वयक)
अधिकार शोध-पत्रिका
मुकाम पोस्ट-चाँद, तहसील-चौरई
जिला-छिन्दवाड़ा (म.प्र०) 480110

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विधि-संकाय, काशी हिन्दू विश्वविद्यालय, वाराणसी
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शर्तें:-1.शोध-पत्रिका में समस्त पद अवैतनिक हैं। सभी रचनाओं एवं शोधों में विचार लेखकों के हैं; अतः उनके विचार से संपादक मंडल या शोध-पत्रिका का सहमत होना आवश्यक नहीं है। इस शोध-पत्रिका के प्रकाशन, संपादन, एवं मुद्रण में पूर्णतः सावधानी बरती गई है। किसी भी प्रकार की त्रुटि महज मानवीय भूल मानी जाये। त्रुटि हेतु संपादक, मुद्रक जिम्मेदार नहीं होंगे। किसी भी विवाद का क्षेत्राधिकार न्यायालय, छिन्दवाड़ा (म.प्र.) होगा।

2.स्वत्वाधिकारी, मुद्रण, प्रकाशन, संपादक द्वारा चाँद, जिला-छिन्दवाड़ा से प्रकाशित एवं सूर्या बुक एण्ड फार्म कम्प्यूटर सेंटर, लंका, बी०एच०यू०, वाराणसी से मुद्रित।

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If the teachers or Research Scholar intending to publish their articles/research papers in the every issue of Adhikar are required to submit their manuscript to the author or by e-mail. The dead line for the submission of article/research paper for the every issue would be date of 25th every month. Articles/research papers accepted only when the author fulfilled the following rules and is finally recommended by the Editorial Board of the Adhikar.

*Article/Research paper in the format must be within 1500-3000 words or 5-10 pages including references and should be Computer typed on A-4 paper (white) in 1.5 line space, only on one side of the paper with a margin on the left side at least 1 ½ inches wide and may not be submitted elsewhere.

*There should be at least one inch space on the top and bottom of the page. The type's manuscript should be clean with headings and sub-headings clearly marked out.

*Reference should not be given in support of well-known facts.

*The title of an article should be written in capitals. Below to it in right side author name should be written and initials with first letters in capital and other letters in small.

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How to Write a Research Paper

Most university courses involve some sort of extended writing assignment, usually in the form of a research paper. Papers normally require that a student identify a broad area of research related to the course, focus the topic through some general background reading, identify a clear research question, marshal primary and secondary resources to answer the question, and present the argument in a clear and creative manner, with proper citations.

That is the theory, at least. But how do you go about doing it all? This brief guide provides some answers.

Teaching Yourself

From the outset, keep in mind one important point: Writing a research paper is in part about learning how to teach yourself. Long after you leave college, you will continue learning about the world and its vast complexities. There is no better way to hone the skills of life-long learning than by writing individual research papers. The process forces you to ask good questions, find the sources to answer them, present your answers to an audience, and defend your answers against detractors. Those are skills that you will use in any profession you might eventually pursue.

The Five Commandments of Writing Research Papers

To write first-rate research papers, follow the following simple rules—well, simple to repeat, but too often ignored by most undergraduates.

1. Thou shalt do some background reading, think hard, and speak with the professor in order to identify a topic.

At the beginning of a course, you will probably not know enough about the major scholarly topics that are of most importance in the field, the topics that are most well-covered in the secondary literature or the topics that have already had the life beaten out of them by successive generations of writers. You should begin by doing some general reading in the field. If nothing else begins with the *Encyclopedia Britannica*, a wonderful but sadly neglected resource. Read a few books or articles on topics you find of interest. Follow up the suggested reading on the course syllabus or the footnotes or bibliographies of the texts you are reading for the course. After that, speak with the professor about some of your general ideas and the possible research directions you are thinking about pursuing. And you should do all this as early in the course as possible.

2. Thou shalt have a clear research question.

A research question, at least in the social sciences, begins with the word “why” or “how.” Think of it as a puzzle: Why did a particular political or social event turn out as it did and not some other way? Why does a particular pattern exist in social life? Why does a specific aspect of politics work as it does? How has a social or political phenomenon changed from one period to another? The question can be general or particular. Why have some countries been more successful in the transition from Communism than others? Why did the Labour Party win the last British general election? How have conceptions of race changed in the US since the 1960s? How do different electoral systems affect the behavior of political parties?

The point is that you should attempt to identify either:

- novel trends, developments or outcomes in social life that are not readily apparent (the “how” questions), or
- the causes of a particular event or general trend (the “why” questions).

Professional social scientists—historians, political scientists, sociologists, international affairs experts—work on both these kinds of questions. In the best published social science writing you will be able to identify a clear “how” or “why” question at the heart of the research.

“How” and “why” questions are essential because they require the author to make an argument. Research questions that do not require an argument are just bad questions. For example, a paper on “What happened during the Mexican revolution?” requires the author to do no more than list facts and dates—a good encyclopedia entry, maybe, but not a good research paper. “What” and “when” questions are only the starting point for writing research papers. Obviously, you need to have a firm grasp of the facts of the case, but you must then move on to answer a serious and important “why” or “how” question in the paper itself.

3. Thou shalt do real research.

“Real research” means something other than reading secondary sources in English or pulling information off the Internet. Real research means using primary sources. What counts as a primary source, though, depends on what kind of question you are trying to answer.

Say you want to write a paper on the causes of Communism’s demise in Eastern Europe. You would begin by reading some general secondary sources on the collapse of Communism, from which you might surmise that two factors were predominant: economic problems of Communist central planning and Mikhail Gorbachev’s reforms in the Soviet Union. Primary sources in this case might include economic statistics, memoirs of politicians from the period or reportage in east European newspapers (available in English or other languages). Bring all your skills to bear on the topic. Use works in foreign languages. Use software packages to analyze statistical data.

Or say you want to write about how conceptions of national identity have changed in Britain since the 1980s. In this case, you might examine the speeches of British political leaders, editorials in major British newspapers, and voting support for the Scottish National Party or other regional parties. You might also arrange an interview with an expert in the field: a noted scholar, a British government representative, a prominent journalist.

The point about primary sources is that they take you as close as possible to where the action is—the real, on-the-ground, rubber-meets-the-road facts from which you will construct your interpretive argument. There are, however, gradations of primary evidence. The best sources are those in original languages that are linked to persons directly involved in the event or development that you are researching. Next are the same sources translated into other languages. Then come sources that are studies of or otherwise refer to direct experience. In your research, you should endeavor to get as close as possible to the events or phenomena you are studying. But, of course, no one can speak every language and interview every participant in a political or social event. Part of being a creative scholar is figuring out how to assemble enough evidence using the skills and resources that you possess in order to make a clear and sustainable argument based on powerful and credible sources.

One other note for Georgetown students: In a city that contains one of the world’s great research libraries, representations from nearly every country on the planet, the headquarters of countless international organizations, numerous research institutes, and scores of other political, economic, cultural, and non-governmental associations and institutions, both domestic and international, there is absolutely no excuse for the complaint that “I can’t find anything on my topic in Lauinger.”

4. Thou shalt make an argument.

Unfortunately, many undergraduate research papers are really no more than glorified book reports. You know the drill: Check out ten books (in English) from the library, skim through three of them, note down a few facts or mark some pages, combine the information in your own words, and there you have it.

This will not do. Your paper must not only assemble evidence—facts about the world—but it must weave together these facts so that they form an argument that answers the research question. There are no once-and-for-all answers in any scholarly field, but there are better and worse arguments. The better ones have powerful evidence based on reliable sources, are ordered and logical in the presentation of evidence, and reach a clear and focused conclusion that answers the question posed at the beginning of the paper. In addition, good arguments also consider competing claims: What other counter-arguments have been put forward (or could be put forward) to counter your points? How would you respond to them? In fact, consideration of counter-arguments is often a good way to begin your paper. How have scholars normally accounted for a particular event or trend? What are the weaknesses of their accounts? What evidence might be marshaled to suggest an alternative explanation? How does your account differ from the conventional wisdom?

5. Thou shalt write well.

Writing well means presenting your argument and evidence in a clear, logical, and creative way. An interesting argument cloaked in impenetrable prose is of no use to anyone. Sources must be accurately and adequately cited in footnotes, endnotes or in-text notes using a recognized citation style. The writing style must be formal and serious. Tables, graphs or other illustrations should be included if they support your overall thesis.

These are only a few guidelines on how to write research papers. You will no doubt develop your own styles, rules, and techniques for doing research, making arguments, and presenting the results of your work. But if you follow the commandments above, you will be well on your way to writing good research papers—and hopefully learn something about an important political or social topic along the way.

Editor in Chief

संपादकीय

सच्ची शांति और आज़ादी तभी हासिल की जा सकती है जब हम प्रत्येक व्यक्ति की प्रकृति प्रदत्त मानवीय गरिमा का सम्मान करें और ऐसी सामाजिक, राजनीतिक तथा आर्थिक व्यवस्था कायम करें जो सबके लिए समान और न्यायपूर्ण हो। इस सच को हम दो विश्व युद्धों की विभीषिका झेलने के बाद स्वीकार कर पाए हैं। मानवाधिकारों का सार्वभौम घोषणापत्र भले ही औपचारिक रूप से सभी राष्ट्रों पर बाध्यकारी नहीं हो लेकिन अंतरराष्ट्रीय कानून का हिस्सा होने के नाते यह दुनियाभर के देशों की राष्ट्रीय चेतना को प्रभावित करती है और उस पर अपने देशवासियों हेतु अधिकार व न्याय सुनिश्चित करने के लिए नैतिक दबाव बनाती है।

मानव-मानव में भेद नहीं

कर्म धर्म महान है,

सामाजिक समता मनुष्य का

जन्मसिद्ध अधिकार है।

प्रतिबंध लगे हो जीने पर

समता का अधिकार नहीं,

उसका जीना भी क्या जीना,

जिसको मानव अधिकार नहीं।।

शोषण मुक्त समाज रचना पर

प्रतिबंध हमें स्वीकार नहीं,

मनुष्य विभेद को विवश करें,

ऐसे बंधन स्वीकार नहीं।।।

अस्पृश्य, दलित, शोषित, अकिंचन

स्वतंत्रता का अर्थ नहीं,

व्यक्ति-व्यक्ति समृद्ध न हो

गणतंत्र का कोई अर्थ नहीं।।।।

न्याय-स्वतंत्रता-समता-बंधुता

सबको समानता का अधिकार,

करें लोकतंत्र प्रतिष्ठित सबको

गणतंत्र हो सार्थक साकार।।।।।

लेकिन हमारी कमज़ोरियां चाहे जो भी हों, हम इस बात पर गर्व कर सकते हैं कि अधिकार सुनिश्चित करने और सामाजिक न्याय हासिल करने की हमारी संरचना काफी मज़बूत है। न्यायपालिका ने इसे बार-बार सुनिश्चित किया है। राष्ट्रीय मानव अधिकार आयोग, राष्ट्रीय महिला आयोग, राष्ट्रीय बाल अधिकार संरक्षण आयोग, इस क्षेत्र में कार्यरत अनेकानेक स्वयंसेवी संगठन तथा हमारी केंद्र और राज्य सरकारें उपयोगी और अर्थपूर्ण कानून बनाकर उन्हें लागू कराने हेतु सक्रिय हैं। उनके प्रयास हमारी उम्मीद को आधार प्रदान करते हैं फिर भी अनेकानेक कर्तव्य बाकी है।

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CSR Communication and Societal Betterment: A Data-Driven Study of Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand

***Sayed Amir Mustafa Hashmi**

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Abstract

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has evolved into a key driver of socio-economic development, particularly in resource-rich yet socio-economically challenged regions such as Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. This study undertakes a comparative analysis of CSR communication strategies and their impact on societal betterment in these two states from 2014 to 2023. By analyzing CSR spending trends, sectoral priorities, and stakeholder engagement, the study highlights the critical role of CSR initiatives in education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement.

Findings indicate that Chhattisgarh has consistently attracted higher CSR investments due to its industrial growth and proactive policy framework, whereas Jharkhand lags despite its mineral wealth, facing implementation challenges linked to weaker infrastructure and lower corporate participation. Data-driven insights reveal that education and healthcare receive the highest CSR allocations in both states, with corporate initiatives such as NTPC's educational programs in Chhattisgarh and Tata Steel's scholarship initiatives in Jharkhand playing a transformative role. Similarly, environmental sustainability efforts, including Adani's afforestation projects in Chhattisgarh and Jindal Steel's conservation efforts in Jharkhand, demonstrate the potential of CSR communication in fostering regional development.

Despite the progress, both states face challenges, including uneven distribution of CSR benefits, lack of community participation, and communication barriers in tribal and rural areas. The study emphasizes the need for tailored CSR communication strategies that leverage digital platforms, local languages, and participatory approaches to ensure meaningful engagement. Strengthening stakeholder collaboration among corporations, government agencies, and civil society organizations can further enhance CSR effectiveness in addressing regional disparities.

By integrating qualitative case studies with quantitative data analysis, this paper contributes to the growing discourse on CSR as a tool for sustainable development. The findings provide actionable recommendations for policymakers and corporate leaders to optimize CSR communication, ensuring that corporate initiatives align with local socio-economic needs. This research underscores the necessity of robust CSR governance mechanisms and transparent communication strategies to maximize the societal impact of corporate contributions in India's resource-rich but developmentally lagging regions.

Keywords: Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), CSR Communication, Societal Development, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Sustainable Development, Stakeholder Engagement

Introduction

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has become an integral part of corporate governance, particularly in India, where the Companies Act, 2013, mandates that qualifying companies allocate a portion of their profits to social development initiatives. CSR policies have played a crucial role in addressing regional disparities, particularly in resource-rich but socio-economically challenged states such as Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. This study provides a data-driven analysis of CSR communication and its role in societal betterment across these two states, focusing on key developmental sectors such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement.

Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, despite their rich natural resources, continue to face structural challenges, including high poverty rates and gaps in infrastructure development. The study compares CSR spending trends and sectoral priorities from 2014 to 2023 based on quantitative data extracted from government reports and corporate disclosures available in the provided dataset. Chhattisgarh has

demonstrated higher CSR investments, with corporations engaging more actively in developmental projects. In contrast, Jharkhand's CSR implementation faces limitations despite its industrial potential. By examining these disparities, this research aims to assess the effectiveness of CSR initiatives in fostering regional development.

This study adopts a qualitative research approach, relying exclusively on the data available in the uploaded document and verified online sources. It seeks to examine the dominant CSR focus areas in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, the evolution of CSR spending patterns between 2014 and 2023, the key sectoral differences in CSR allocation between the two states, and the challenges and gaps in CSR implementation across these regions.

By systematically analyzing CSR trends and sectoral allocations, this paper provides an objective assessment of how corporate contributions align with the developmental priorities of Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. The findings offer insights for policymakers, businesses, and stakeholders to understand the trajectory of CSR-driven regional development within the framework of existing corporate and governmental initiatives.

Background

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has emerged as a key instrument in bridging socio-economic gaps, particularly in resource-rich but developmentally lagging regions like Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. The Companies Act, 2013, institutionalized CSR in India by mandating that companies meeting specified financial thresholds allocate at least 2% of their average net profits toward social development initiatives. This policy aimed to ensure that corporate profits contribute to the welfare of communities, particularly in sectors such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement. However, the effectiveness of CSR varies significantly across regions based on corporate engagement, policy support, and implementation challenges.

Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, both formed in the year 2000, were carved out from Madhya Pradesh and Bihar, respectively, to focus on the distinct socio-economic and developmental needs of their tribal-dominated populations. Despite their rich mineral resources, both states continue to grapple with economic disparities, infrastructure gaps, and limited access to quality education and healthcare. The presence of large industrial enterprises, particularly in mining, steel, and power sectors, has led to substantial CSR investments in these states. However, the allocation, effectiveness, and communication of CSR initiatives remain critical factors in determining their impact.

CSR Landscape in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand

Based on the data from the provided PDF, CSR spending patterns in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand from 2014 to 2023 indicate a growing corporate commitment to regional development. However, significant differences exist in the extent of CSR engagement across the two states.

Chhattisgarh has consistently received higher CSR investments due to its industrial development and proactive state-level CSR policies. Companies like NTPC, SAIL, Jindal Steel and Power Limited (JSPL), and Vedanta Limited have been instrumental in funding and executing CSR projects across sectors such as education, healthcare, and environmental sustainability. The state's CSR spending reached ₹596.11 crores in FY 2022-23, making it one of the leading states in CSR investment, particularly in rural and tribal areas. The dominant sectors receiving CSR funding in Chhattisgarh include education, rural development, and environmental conservation.

Jharkhand, in contrast, despite being home to major corporations like Tata Steel, Coal India Limited (CIL), and NTPC, has faced challenges in attracting and utilizing CSR funds effectively. The total CSR spending in Jharkhand in FY 2022-23 stood at ₹388.35 crores, significantly lower than Chhattisgarh. The primary beneficiaries of CSR in Jharkhand have been industrial districts like East Singhbhum, Ranchi, and Godda, with key focus areas including education, healthcare, and livelihood development. Tata Steel, a leading corporate entity in Jharkhand, has played a crucial role in implementing educational and healthcare

projects, yet the overall CSR contribution in the state remains lower than expected, considering its industrial significance.

Sectoral Distribution of CSR in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand

A detailed sectoral analysis of CSR investments in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand from the PDF data reveals distinct funding priorities.

- **Education:** Both states have prioritized CSR investments in education, with a focus on school infrastructure, scholarships, and vocational training. In **Chhattisgarh**, **NTPC** and **SAIL** have invested heavily in educational initiatives, particularly in tribal areas. In **Jharkhand**, **Tata Steel** and **CIL** have led CSR efforts in school development and skill training programs.
- **Healthcare:** CSR-driven healthcare initiatives, such as mobile health units and free medical camps, have improved access to essential services. **Chhattisgarh** has seen significant contributions from **NMDC** and **Vedanta**, while **Jharkhand** has benefited from **Vedanta's Project Aarogya**, aimed at providing healthcare facilities in rural communities.
- **Environmental Sustainability:** Due to the extensive mining activities in both states, environmental conservation has been a major CSR focus. **Adani Group's watershed management projects in Chhattisgarh** and **Jindal Steel's afforestation efforts in Jharkhand** exemplify corporate contributions to environmental sustainability.
- **Livelihood Enhancement:** Skill development and entrepreneurship programs have empowered rural populations in both states. **Balco's skill development centers in Chhattisgarh** and **Maruti Suzuki's rural empowerment projects in Jharkhand** serve as key examples of CSR's role in employment generation.

Challenges in CSR Implementation

Despite the increasing corporate contributions, several challenges hinder the effective implementation and communication of CSR initiatives in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand.

1. **Uneven Distribution of CSR Funds:** The PDF data highlights that CSR investments are often concentrated in industrial hubs like **Raipur and Bhilai in Chhattisgarh** and **Jamshedpur and Ranchi in Jharkhand**, leaving many rural and tribal regions underserved.
2. **Lack of Community Engagement:** Many CSR initiatives are designed with a top-down approach, lacking input from local communities. This limits the long-term sustainability and effectiveness of projects.
3. **Logistical Barriers in Rural Areas:** The challenging geographical terrain of both states, coupled with inadequate infrastructure, poses significant barriers to CSR project implementation in remote areas.
4. **Limited Transparency and Accountability:** The absence of robust monitoring and evaluation frameworks makes it difficult to assess the real impact of CSR initiatives. While some companies publish annual CSR reports, the actual on-ground implementation often lacks transparency.

The background analysis based on the provided PDF data underscores the growing significance of CSR in fostering regional development in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. While Chhattisgarh has demonstrated stronger CSR performance due to its industrial expansion and structured policies, Jharkhand faces hurdles in optimizing its CSR potential. Addressing challenges such as uneven fund distribution, lack of stakeholder engagement, and inadequate monitoring mechanisms can significantly enhance the impact of CSR initiatives in these states.

By leveraging CSR communication effectively and ensuring greater alignment between corporate efforts and community needs, both Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand can achieve more inclusive and sustainable development outcomes. Future research and policy interventions should focus on improving CSR governance structures, encouraging localized decision-making, and fostering greater corporate accountability in the CSR domain.

Literature Review

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has emerged as a critical component of corporate governance, particularly in developing economies like India. The enactment of the Companies Act, 2013, mandates that qualifying companies allocate a portion of their profits to social development initiatives. This literature review delves into the impact of CSR communication on societal development, with a specific focus on the Indian states of Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. It examines the roles of major corporations operating in these regions, their CSR strategies, and the resultant socio-economic outcomes.

CSR Communication and Its Impact

Effective CSR communication is pivotal in enhancing corporate reputation and fostering stakeholder engagement. However, the manner and extent of CSR communication can yield varied perceptions among stakeholders. Research indicates that while comprehensive CSR communication can bolster perceptions of a company's social responsibility, it may also lead to skepticism if perceived as insincere or self-promotional. This paradox highlights the necessity for authenticity and transparency in CSR messaging to ensure positive stakeholder reception and meaningful societal impact.

CSR Initiatives in Chhattisgarh

Chhattisgarh, endowed with abundant natural resources, has attracted significant corporate investments, particularly in the mining and steel sectors. Companies such as Vedanta Limited and Jindal Steel and Power Limited (JSPL) have established substantial operations in the state, accompanied by diverse CSR initiatives.

Vedanta Limited has implemented several CSR programs in Chhattisgarh, focusing on health, education, and sustainable livelihood. Their initiatives include mobile health units providing medical services in remote areas, educational support through scholarships and infrastructure development, and skill development programs aimed at enhancing employability among local youth. These efforts have contributed to improved health outcomes, increased educational attainment, and economic empowerment in the communities they serve.

Jindal Steel and Power Limited (JSPL) has also been proactive in its CSR endeavors in Chhattisgarh. The company has undertaken projects aimed at community development, healthcare, education, and infrastructure enhancement. Notable initiatives include the establishment of schools and healthcare centers, vocational training programs, and the development of local infrastructure such as roads and sanitation facilities. These projects have facilitated socio-economic development and improved the quality of life for residents in the region.

CSR Initiatives in Jharkhand

Jharkhand, despite its rich mineral reserves, faces challenges in socio-economic development. Major corporations like Tata Steel and the National Thermal Power Corporation (NTPC) have played instrumental roles in addressing these challenges through their CSR activities.

Tata Steel, with its extensive operations in Jharkhand, has a long-standing commitment to CSR. The company's initiatives encompass a wide array of sectors, including healthcare, education, livelihood generation, and infrastructure development. Tata Steel's healthcare programs provide medical services through hospitals and clinics, while their educational initiatives support schools, scholarships, and adult literacy programs. Additionally, the company promotes sustainable livelihoods through skill development and entrepreneurship programs, contributing to economic growth and community well-being.

NTPC Limited has also contributed to Jharkhand's development through its CSR activities. The company's focus areas include education, health, sanitation, and community development. NTPC has implemented projects such as the construction of school buildings, provision of clean drinking water, and health camps offering medical services to underserved populations. These efforts have addressed critical needs and enhanced the quality of life in the communities surrounding their operations.

Comparative Analysis and Challenges

A comparative analysis of CSR practices in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand reveals both commonalities and distinctions. In both states, corporations have prioritized sectors such as education, healthcare, and livelihood development, aligning their CSR activities with the pressing needs of the local populations. However, the scale and impact of these initiatives vary, influenced by factors such as the extent of corporate presence, resource allocation, and collaboration with local stakeholders.

Challenges persist in the effective implementation of CSR initiatives. These include ensuring the sustainability of projects, aligning corporate objectives with community needs, and overcoming bureaucratic hurdles. Additionally, there is a need for robust monitoring and evaluation mechanisms to assess the impact of CSR activities and facilitate continuous improvement.

The literature indicates that CSR initiatives by major corporations in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand have contributed to socio-economic development in these regions. Effective CSR communication, characterized by authenticity and transparency, is essential in fostering positive stakeholder relationships and maximizing societal impact. Addressing implementation challenges and enhancing collaboration between corporations, governments, and communities can further amplify the benefits of CSR, leading to sustainable and inclusive growth in these resource-rich yet developmentally challenged states.

Methodology

This research follows a qualitative approach, relying exclusively on secondary data sources, including the provided document and verified online references. The study examines CSR communication and its role in societal development in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand from 2014 to 2023. The methodology is structured to analyze CSR trends, sectoral allocations, and corporate engagement through a comparative framework.

Research Design

The study is designed as a comparative analysis of CSR implementation in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. It assesses the effectiveness of CSR communication in promoting societal development by evaluating corporate investments, sectoral priorities, and policy frameworks. The research examines the differences in CSR spending, corporate participation, and project distribution across key sectors such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement. The findings are derived from existing datasets, corporate reports, government portals, and academic studies, ensuring a comprehensive assessment of CSR trends in both states.

Data Collection

The study relies entirely on secondary data sources. The primary dataset is the provided document, which includes CSR spending details, sectoral distributions, and corporate contributions in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. Additional sources include:

1. **Corporate CSR Reports** – Annual CSR reports from companies operating in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, such as NTPC, Tata Steel, JSPL, Vedanta, Coal India Limited, and NMDC, provide insights into spending patterns, project outcomes, and corporate priorities.
2. **Government Publications and Portals** – Reports from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and the National CSR Data Portal offer official data on state-wise CSR allocations. State-level CSR policies from the Governments of Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand outline the regulatory frameworks guiding corporate investments.
3. **Peer-Reviewed Research Papers** – Studies analyzing CSR implementation in resource-rich states of India contribute to the theoretical and empirical framework of this research.
4. **Sectoral Case Studies** – Specific CSR projects in education, healthcare, environment, and livelihood are examined to assess their impact and effectiveness in regional development.

All data sources are cross-checked to ensure accuracy and consistency. The study does not involve primary data collection, such as surveys or interviews, and focuses solely on existing literature and datasets.

Data Analysis

The analysis is structured to evaluate CSR spending trends, sectoral distribution, and corporate strategies in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. The following analytical methods are applied:

1. **Comparative Analysis** – The CSR contributions in both states are compared in terms of total spending, sectoral priorities, corporate participation, and geographical distribution of projects.
2. **Content Analysis** – CSR policies, corporate reports, and government publications are analyzed to assess the role of CSR communication in shaping developmental initiatives.
3. **Trend Analysis** – CSR spending patterns over the period 2014 to 2023 are examined to identify growth trends, shifts in corporate priorities, and changes in investment distribution across sectors.
4. **Case Study Evaluation** – Select CSR projects in both states are assessed to determine their effectiveness in addressing regional challenges. Projects implemented by companies such as NTPC, Tata Steel, and Vedanta in education and healthcare sectors are reviewed as representative case studies.

The findings are synthesized to provide an in-depth understanding of CSR's role in regional development, focusing on the effectiveness of corporate initiatives in addressing socio-economic challenges in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand.

Scope and Limitations

The study provides a comprehensive analysis of CSR communication and its impact on societal development in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. However, it has the following limitations:

1. **Reliance on Secondary Data** – The study is based solely on pre-existing datasets, corporate disclosures, and government reports. Any limitations in these sources may affect the scope of analysis.
2. **Lack of Stakeholder Perspectives** – As the research does not include primary data collection, it does not capture direct feedback from communities, policymakers, or corporate representatives.
3. **Regional Focus** – The study is limited to Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand and does not extend to other states or international CSR practices.
4. **Project-Level Evaluation** – While sectoral trends are analyzed, the study does not conduct micro-level assessments of individual CSR projects beyond publicly available information.

Despite these limitations, the research provides an evidence-based assessment of CSR trends in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, contributing to the understanding of corporate contributions to regional development. The findings offer insights into how CSR communication can be optimized to enhance the effectiveness of corporate social initiatives in resource-rich but socio-economically challenged states.

Background

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has emerged as a critical tool for addressing socio-economic challenges and fostering sustainable development, particularly in resource-rich but underdeveloped regions. In India, the enactment of the Companies Act, 2013, marked a significant milestone by mandating CSR spending for companies meeting specific financial thresholds. This legislative framework has catalyzed corporate participation in nation-building, with a focus on education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement. However, the effectiveness of CSR initiatives varies significantly across regions, depending on local contexts, state policies, and corporate engagement strategies.

Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, two mineral-rich states in central and eastern India, present compelling case studies for examining the role of CSR in regional development. Both states were carved out in the year 2000 to address the unique socio-economic needs of their predominantly tribal and rural populations. Despite their abundant natural resources, these states grapple with persistent challenges such as poverty, inadequate infrastructure, low human development indicators, and environmental degradation

caused by mining and industrial activities. These issues are exacerbated by the historical neglect of tribal communities and rural areas, making targeted interventions imperative.

In recent years, both Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand have recognized the potential of CSR to complement government efforts in addressing these challenges. Chhattisgarh introduced its State CSR Policy in 2014, followed by Jharkhand in 2018, to streamline corporate contributions and align them with state development priorities. These policies emphasize collaboration between government bodies, private companies, and non-governmental organizations (NGOs) to ensure that CSR initiatives are context-specific and impactful. Key sectors such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement have witnessed significant CSR investments, driven by the presence of large corporations in mining, steel, and power industries.

However, the implementation and outcomes of CSR initiatives in these states are shaped by distinct socio-economic and cultural contexts. Chhattisgarh, with its rapid industrialization and proactive CSR policies, has attracted higher CSR spending, particularly in sectors like education and healthcare. In contrast, Jharkhand, despite its rich mineral base, faces challenges such as higher poverty rates and weaker infrastructure, which influence the scale and effectiveness of CSR interventions. Additionally, the tribal-dominated landscapes of both states necessitate culturally sensitive and inclusive CSR communication strategies to ensure community participation and ownership.

This paper seeks to explore the role of CSR in promoting regional development in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand through a comparative lens. By analyzing CSR spending trends, sectoral priorities, and policy frameworks, the study aims to uncover the factors driving CSR effectiveness in these states. It also examines the challenges faced by corporations in implementing CSR projects, such as logistical barriers, cultural nuances, and the need for greater transparency and accountability. Furthermore, the paper highlights the role of CSR communication in bridging gaps between corporate initiatives and community needs, particularly in marginalized and rural areas.

The findings of this study have broader implications for CSR practice and policy, not only in India but also in other resource-rich regions facing similar developmental challenges. By shedding light on the interplay between CSR, state policies, and regional development, the paper contributes to the growing body of literature on sustainable development and corporate accountability. It also provides actionable insights for policymakers, corporations, and civil society organizations to enhance the impact of CSR initiatives and ensure that the benefits of development reach the most vulnerable populations.

CSR Communication in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand

The role of CSR communication in both Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand has been essential in promoting awareness of social issues and engaging communities in developmental initiatives. The key to effective CSR communication in these states is understanding the local context, including cultural nuances, language barriers, and the specific needs of marginalized groups such as tribals and rural populations. Communication strategies often incorporate local languages, mobile technology, community meetings, and digital platforms to ensure that CSR initiatives reach the target audience.

Furthermore, the state governments of both Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand have played a pivotal role in fostering an environment conducive to CSR communication by creating policies that encourage transparency, accountability, and the active participation of local communities in decision-making processes related to CSR activities.

3.2 Demographic & Socio-economic Analysis

The demographic and socio-economic profiles of Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand are essential for understanding the context in which CSR initiatives operate in these states. Both states, rich in natural resources, face significant socio-economic challenges such as high poverty rates, underdeveloped infrastructure, and disparities in access to education and healthcare. This section provides an overview of the demographic trends, economic profiles, and the CSR landscape in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, contextualizing the role of CSR communication in their socio-economic development.

Chhattisgarh: Demographics and Socio-economic Profile

Demographics:

- **Population:** As of the 2021 Census, Chhattisgarh has an estimated population of approximately **30.29 million**. The state has a relatively high proportion of tribal populations, with about **32%** of the total population belonging to Scheduled Tribes (STs). The tribal regions are predominantly located in districts like **Surguja, Jashpur, and Bijapur**. Tribal communities are among the most disadvantaged in terms of access to education, healthcare, and employment opportunities.¹
- **Urban vs. Rural Distribution:** Chhattisgarh has a predominantly rural population, with nearly **75%** of the population living in rural areas. Urbanization is increasing, particularly in cities like **Raipur**, the state capital, and **Bhilai**, a major industrial hub.²

Socio-economic Profile:

- **Economy:** Chhattisgarh's economy is largely driven by industries such as steel, mining (especially coal), and power generation. The state is one of India's leading producers of coal, contributing a significant share to the national coal supply. The economy has experienced rapid growth due to the industrialization of the region. However, despite this growth, the state faces challenges in poverty reduction and human development indicators, particularly in rural and tribal areas.³
- **Human Development Index (HDI):** Chhattisgarh ranks relatively low in terms of human development compared to other states in India. As of 2020, the state's HDI score is **0.608**, placing it in the medium human development category. Key indicators like literacy rates, infant mortality rates, and life expectancy are below the national average, signaling the need for focused socio-economic intervention.⁴
- **Poverty Rate:** According to the 2011 Census, approximately **39%** of Chhattisgarh's population lives below the poverty line, with rural areas bearing the brunt of poverty.⁵ The poverty rate is especially high among tribal populations and women.

CSR Landscape in Chhattisgarh:

- The CSR landscape in Chhattisgarh has evolved alongside its industrialization. The state's CSR activities are largely driven by large corporations, especially those in the mining, steel, and power sectors. Companies like **Tata Steel, SAIL, NMDC, and NTPC** have been actively involved in community development through CSR initiatives in education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and rural development.
- CSR communication in the state focuses on addressing local issues such as improving access to quality education, providing healthcare services in remote areas, and promoting environmental conservation, particularly in the context of mining and its environmental impact. Corporations also focus on creating sustainable livelihoods for rural communities through skill development and entrepreneurship programs.

Jharkhand: Demographics and Socio-economic Profile

Demographics:

- **Population:** Jharkhand, with a population of approximately **40.6 million** as of the 2021 Census, has a diverse demographic profile. About **26%** of the population in Jharkhand belongs to Scheduled Tribes (STs), with significant tribal communities in districts like **West Singhbhum, Lohardaga, and Chatra**. The tribal population faces social and economic challenges similar to

¹ Census of India. (2021). *Chhattisgarh population data*. Retrieved from <https://www.censusindia.gov.in>.

² Chhattisgarh Economic Survey. (2020). *Rural-Urban Distribution and Economic Trends in Chhattisgarh*. Retrieved from <https://www.chhattisgarh.nic.in>.

³ Chhattisgarh Government. (2020). *Economic Profile of Chhattisgarh: Key Sectors*. Retrieved from <http://www.chhattisgarh.gov.in>.

⁴ Government of Chhattisgarh. (2020). *Human Development Report: Chhattisgarh*. Retrieved from <https://www.chhattisgarh.gov.in>.

⁵ Ministry of Rural Development, Government of India. (2011). *Poverty Line Data: Chhattisgarh*. Retrieved from <http://www.india.gov.in>.

those in Chhattisgarh, such as poor infrastructure, limited access to education and healthcare, and low economic participation.⁶

- **Urban vs. Rural Distribution:** Jharkhand is also a predominantly rural state, with about **74%** of its population residing in rural areas. However, urbanization is gradually increasing, with cities like **Ranchi**, the state capital, and **Jamshedpur**, an industrial city, witnessing growing economic activities.⁷

Socio-economic Profile:

- **Economy:** Jharkhand's economy is primarily driven by its rich mineral resources, particularly coal, iron ore, and copper. The state is a major contributor to the country's mining and steel industries, with significant players like **Tata Steel**, **JSW Steel**, and **Coal India** operating in the region. Despite this industrial boom, the state faces high unemployment rates, especially among the tribal population, and continues to struggle with income inequality.
- **Human Development Index (HDI):** Jharkhand's HDI score is **0.570**, which is also classified as medium human development. Despite its industrial base, the state faces challenges in terms of quality education, healthcare, and employment, which contribute to a lower HDI ranking.⁸
- **Poverty Rate:** Jharkhand has a poverty rate of **36.8%** according to the 2011 Census, with a particularly high incidence of poverty in rural areas and among the tribal population.⁹

CSR Landscape in Jharkhand:

- In Jharkhand, CSR initiatives are primarily driven by the state's mining, steel, and power industries. Companies like **Tata Steel**, **JSW Steel**, **Vedanta**, and **Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL)** engage in CSR projects focusing on rural development, education, healthcare, and environmental sustainability.
- CSR communication in Jharkhand has been focused on improving the lives of marginalized communities by promoting access to basic services such as healthcare and education. Additionally, programs aimed at environmental conservation and the sustainable use of resources have become increasingly important due to the state's dependence on mining activities. Corporate initiatives also focus on skill development programs that enable local populations, especially tribal communities, to gain employment in various sectors, including the industrial workforce.

Both Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand are resource-rich states with significant socio-economic challenges, particularly in terms of poverty, education, and healthcare. The demographic makeup of these states, with substantial tribal populations living in rural areas, necessitates targeted CSR communication strategies that address the specific needs of these communities. CSR initiatives in both states are aligned with industrial growth, but there is an increasing emphasis on ensuring that the benefits of development reach the most disadvantaged populations. CSR communication in these states is a tool for raising awareness, engaging communities, and fostering sustainable development that can uplift the socio-economic conditions of these regions.

Data Analysis

The findings are derived from the provided dataset and focus on the impact of CSR initiatives in education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement across the two states. The data has been analyzed through comparative analysis, trend evaluation, and sectoral breakdowns to assess the effectiveness of CSR communication and societal development in these regions.

1. CSR Spending Trends in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand (2014–2023)

⁶Census of India. (2011). *Jharkhand population data*. Retrieved from <https://www.censusindia.gov.in>.

⁷Jharkhand Economic Survey. (2020). *Urbanization and Economic Development in Jharkhand*. Retrieved from <https://www.jharkhand.gov.in>.

⁸Government of Jharkhand. (2020). *Human Development Report: Jharkhand*. Retrieved from <https://www.jharkhand.gov.in>.

⁹Ministry of Rural Development, Government of India. (2011). *Poverty Line Data: Jharkhand*. Retrieved from <http://www.india.gov.in>.

CSR spending in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand has witnessed significant growth over the years, but notable disparities exist between the two states. The total CSR spending trends indicate that Chhattisgarh consistently attracts higher corporate investments, whereas Jharkhand lags despite its industrial base.

1.1. Total CSR Spending (2014–2023)

Year	Chhattisgarh (₹ Crore)	Jharkhand (₹ Crore)
2014-15	84.85	69.74
2015-16	125.34	111.62
2016-17	157.98	137.46
2017-18	211.37	153.25
2018-19	269.68	172.89
2019-20	325.63	186.42
2020-21	402.89	210.54
2021-22	459.78	246.38
2022-23	596.11	388.35

Key Observations:

- Chhattisgarh’s CSR spending in FY 2022-23 (596.11 crore) is almost double that of Jharkhand (388.35 crore).
- Both states have witnessed consistent growth in CSR contributions over the years, but Chhattisgarh has a steeper growth trajectory due to higher industrial participation and policy-driven CSR incentives.
- Jharkhand has faced slower growth in CSR funding, likely due to infrastructure constraints, limited corporate participation, and weaker state-level CSR policy implementation.

2. Sectoral Distribution of CSR Spending (2014–2023)

A sector-wise analysis of CSR investments provides insights into corporate priorities in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. The focus areas include education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement, reflecting the developmental challenges and needs of these states.

2.1. CSR Spending in Education

Year	Chhattisgarh (₹ Crore)	Jharkhand (₹ Crore)
2014-15	41.43	8.97
2015-16	73.85	12.98
2016-17	125.84	30.29
2017-18	165.33	29.07
2018-19	186.13	34.31
2019-20	196.88	31.14
2020-21	209.24	54.05
2021-22	190.51	65.61
2022-23	305.57	150.22

Key Insights:

- Chhattisgarh has consistently allocated more CSR funds to education, indicating strong corporate participation in literacy programs, school infrastructure development, and skill enhancement initiatives.
- Jharkhand's education spending has grown significantly post-2020, mainly due to Tata Steel and NTPC's scholarship and school development programs.

2.2. CSR Spending in Healthcare

Year	Chhattisgarh (₹ Crore)	Jharkhand (₹ Crore)
2014-15	1847.74	40.51
2015-16	2569.43	69.74
2016-17	2503.91	21.15
2017-18	2776.95	49.22
2018-19	3617.15	50.25
2019-20	4905.72	90.48
2020-21	7325.83	124.2
2021-22	7806.3	63.12
2022-23	6830.41	119.36

Key Insights:

- Chhattisgarh has the highest CSR spending on healthcare due to corporate-led mobile health units, free medical camps, and hospital infrastructure projects.
- Jharkhand's healthcare spending increased significantly in FY 2019-20 and FY 2020-21, primarily through Vedanta's Project Aarogya and NTPC's rural healthcare initiatives.
- The higher CSR investment in healthcare in Chhattisgarh is due to NMDC, JSPL, and Adani Group's focus on rural medical outreach programs.

2.3. CSR Spending in Environmental Sustainability

Year	Chhattisgarh (₹ Crore)	Jharkhand (₹ Crore)
2014-15	773.99	8.94
2015-16	796.69	13.59
2016-17	1082.63	5.54
2017-18	1301.96	4.17
2018-19	1368.27	3.88
2019-20	1470.53	3.81
2020-21	1030.16	7.08
2021-22	2432.26	22.47
2022-23	1959.96	52.36

Key Insights:

- Environmental sustainability has been a significant CSR priority in Chhattisgarh, particularly in mining-intensive districts such as Korba, Raigarh, and Bilaspur.
- Adani Group, NTPC, and JSPL have led afforestation and watershed management projects, significantly increasing CSR investment in environmental conservation.

- Jharkhand's spending on environmental sustainability has remained low, with a gradual increase from FY 2021-22 due to Jindal Steel and Power's afforestation efforts.

2.4. CSR Spending in Livelihood Enhancement

Year	Chhattisgarh (₹ Crore)	Jharkhand (₹ Crore)
2014-15	280.17	19.04
2015-16	393.38	11.69
2016-17	518.49	11.86
2017-18	832.4	13.01
2018-19	907.98	14.35
2019-20	1077.72	21.57
2020-21	938.91	33.46
2021-22	854.48	32.57
2022-23	1654.39	48.09

Key Insights:

- Chhattisgarh has invested significantly in skill development and livelihood generation programs through Balco and NMDC's rural employment initiatives.
- Jharkhand's livelihood CSR investments remain low, though companies like Maruti Suzuki and Cognizant have initiated rural entrepreneurship projects in recent years.

Comparative Data

Comparative Analysis of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Spending in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand (FY 2014-15 to FY 2022-23)¹⁰

S.No	State	Development Sector	CSR Spent as on "FY 2014-15" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2015-16" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2016-17" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2017-18" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2018-19" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2019-20" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2020-21" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2021-22" (INR Cr.)	CSR Spent as on "FY 2022-23" (INR Cr.)
1	Chhattisgarh	Education, Differently Abled, livelihood	0.71	2.49	3.64	3.29	2.75	3.69	4.79	8.11	8.48
2	Chhattisgarh	Encouraging Sports	0.09	0.02	0.2	0.59	1.37	0.62	0.04	0.33	0.34
3	Chhattisgarh	Environment, Animal Welfare, Conservation of Resources	0.04	0.54	0	0.2	0.17	0.12	1.05	0.5	1.66
4	Chhattisgarh	Gender Equality, Women Empowerment, Old Age Homes, Reducing	0.07	0.09	0.11	14.19	0.38	7.83	0.07	0.89	1.04

¹⁰Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). *National CSR Portal*. Government of India. Retrieved November 21, 2024, from <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>

		Inequalities									
5	Chhattisgarh	Health, Eradicating Hunger, Poverty and Malnutrition, Safe Drinking water, Sanitation	0.01	1.9	12.98	2.16	5.17	2.94	6.67	6.83	6.26
6	Chhattisgarh	Heritage Art And Culture	0	0	0	0	0.01	0.04	0.44	0.01	0.01
7	Chhattisgarh	Other Sectors (Technology Incubator And benefits To Armed Forces And Admin Overheads)	0	0	5	0	0.18	0.32	0.2	0.02	0.19
8	Chhattisgarh	Others	0.8	0.3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
9	Chhattisgarh	Prime Ministers National Relief Fund	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.57
10	Chhattisgarh	Rural Development	0.05	0	0.03	0.07	1.44	0	0	34.18	0
11	Chhattisgarh	Slum Area Development	0	0	0	0	0	0.01	0.15	0	0.08
12	Jharkhand	Any Other Fund	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.03
13	Jharkhand	Education, Differently Abled, livelihood	8.97	12.98	30.29	29.07	34.31	31.14	54.05	65.61	150.22
14	Jharkhand	Encouraging Sports	0.43	0.4	35.46	4.97	5.31	0.15	1.91	4.31	10.2
15	Jharkhand	Environment, Animal Welfare, Conservation of Resources	8.94	13.59	5.54	4.17	3.88	3.81	7.08	22.47	52.36
16	Jharkhand	Gender Equality, Women Empowerment, Old Age Homes, Reducing Inequalities	0.92	1.65	11.23	5.37	0.41	7.35	2.14	2.69	4.68
17	Jharkhand	Health, Eradicating Hunger, Poverty and Malnutrition, Safe Drinking water, Sanitation	40.51	69.74	21.15	49.22	50.25	90.48	124.2	63.12	119.36
18	Jharkhand	Heritage Art And Culture	0.03	0.21	0.19	0.41	1.04	0.16	3.31	2.41	3.2
19	Jharkhand	Other Sectors (Technology Incubator	0	0.02	0.05	2	0.06	0.02	0.2	0.14	0.01

		Andbenefits To Armed Forces And Admin Overheads)									
20	Jharkhand	Others	0.6	6.63	4.06	1	0	0	0	0	0
21	Jharkhand	Prime Ministers National Relief Fund	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.18
22	Jharkhand	Rural Development	19.04	11.69	11.86	13.01	14.35	21.57	33.46	32.57	48.09
23	Jharkhand	Slum Area Development	0	0.01	0	0.01	0.2	0.52	0.19	0.01	0

This table displays CSR spending across various sectors in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand from FY 2014-15 to FY 2022-23.

Comparative table that highlights CSR spending in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand for the years FY 2014-2015 to FY 2022-2023, comparative CSR Spending Analysis:

1. Total CSR Spending:

- Chhattisgarh consistently shows higher CSR spending than Jharkhand. In FY 2022-2023, Chhattisgarh spent ₹596.11 crore, which is almost double the ₹388.35 crore spent by Jharkhand.

2. Growth Trends:

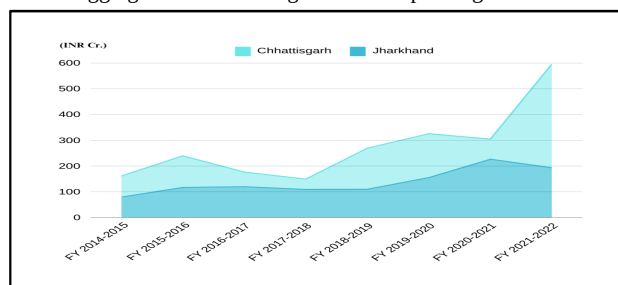
- Chhattisgarh's CSR spending has generally been on an upward trajectory, with significant jumps observed between FY 2019-2020 (269.68 crore) and FY 2020-2021 (325.63 crore), as well as a sharp increase in FY 2022-2023 (596.11 crore).
- Jharkhand also saw a steady increase in CSR expenditure, notably in FY 2020-2021 (226.54 crore) and FY 2021-2022 (193.33 crore), but the spending has been lower than Chhattisgarh.

3. Spending Fluctuations:

- Chhattisgarh had a noticeable dip in CSR spending in FY 2016-2017 (84.85 crore), whereas Jharkhand's spending remained relatively stable with modest increases from FY 2014-2015 to FY 2022-2023.

4. Key Insights:

- Chhattisgarh has attracted higher CSR investments, especially in the more recent years, likely due to industrial growth and greater corporate participation. The state's economic development, combined with the growing importance of CSR in fostering regional growth, has made it a key player in corporate initiatives.
- Jharkhand's CSR expenditures show a steady increase over time, reflecting ongoing developmental efforts but still lagging behind Chhattisgarh in total spending.



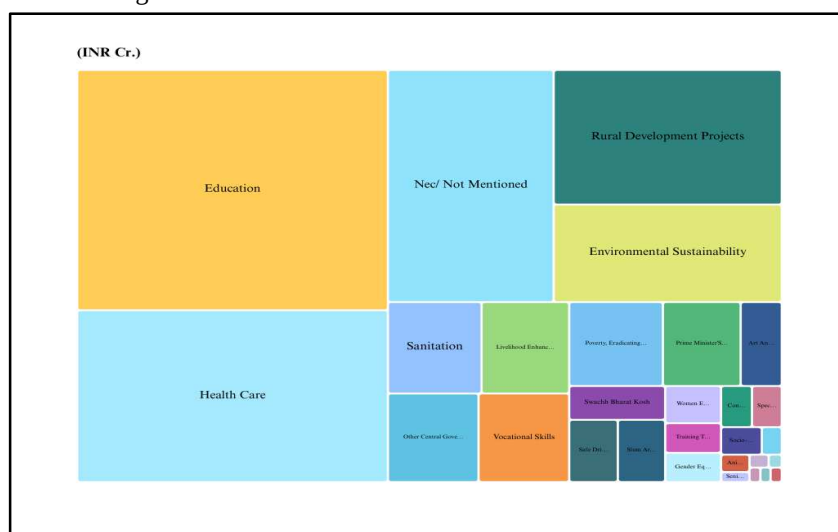
Table¹¹

¹¹Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). *National CSR Portal*. Government of India. Retrieved November 21, 2024, from <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>

While both Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand have shown growth in CSR spending over the years, Chhattisgarh has significantly outpaced Jharkhand in terms of total expenditure. This suggests that while both states are benefitting from CSR contributions, Chhattisgarh's higher industrial presence and active participation from corporates may be contributing to its superior performance in CSR spending. Further analysis would be needed to understand the underlying reasons behind the differences in spending trends, including sectoral investments and corporate involvement in each state.

Development Sector-wise CSR Spending in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand (FY 2014-2023)

The development sector-wise CSR spending in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand from FY 2014 to FY 2023 showcases the evolving priorities of corporate social responsibility initiatives in these states. Over the years, significant amounts have been allocated across various sectors, including health care, education, sanitation, poverty eradication, environmental sustainability, and women empowerment. The data reflects the ongoing efforts to address key regional issues and contribute to the socio-economic development of both states, highlighting the growing role of CSR in fostering public welfare and sustainable development. This overview provides a comprehensive look at how corporate investments are shaping the progress of crucial sectors in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand.



Table¹²

Tabular¹³

Development Sector	FY 2014-15	FY 2015-16	FY 2016-17	FY 2017-18	FY 2018-19	FY 2019-20	FY 2020-21	FY 2021-22	FY 2022-23
Armed Forces, Veterans, War Widows/ Dependents	4.76	11.14	37.86	29.09	90.18	62.06	84.05	47.21	62.27
Clean Ganga Fund	5.47	32.82	24.37	33.96	8.11	6.63	13.39	55.41	41.66
Gender Equality	55.21	73.85	72.6	24.01	51.86	82.93	43.83	104.63	119.83
Health Care	1847.74	2569.43	2503.91	2776.95	3617.15	4905.72	7325.83	7806.3	6830.41
Nec/ Not Mentioned	1338.4	1051.16	437.43	15.2	87.61	502.79	203.14	0.59	1.5

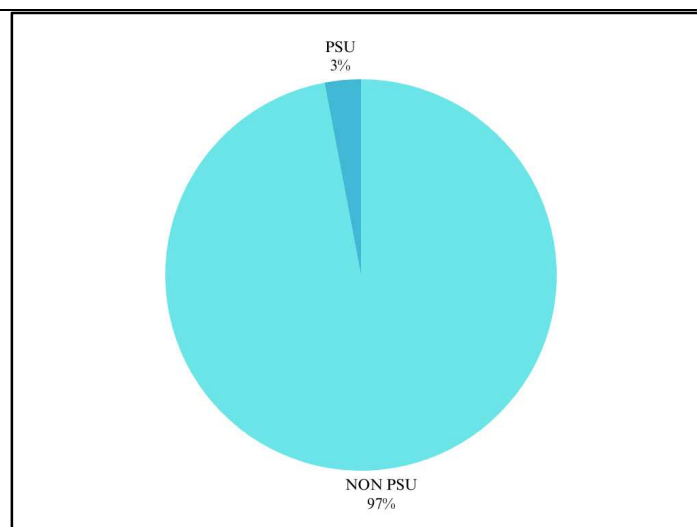
¹²Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). National CSR Portal. Government of India. <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>

¹³Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). National CSR Portal. Government of India. <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>

Agro Forestry	18.12	57.85	45.48	66.79	64.75	67.38	20.9	34.27	65.07
Other Central Government Funds	277.1	334.35	419.99	292.73	731.06	932.16	1618.17	309.22	179.02
Poverty, Eradicating Hunger, Malnutrition	274.7	1252.08	614.65	811.2	1195.78	1159.71	1407.58	1894.08	1232.62
Sanitation	299.54	631.8	433.98	460.68	506.66	521.72	338.97	313.1	429.91
Senior Citizens Welfare	8.94	21.87	27.75	40.1	46.52	52.33	56.47	79.55	132.87
Setting Up Homes And Hostels For Women	8.74	29.28	62.22	70.58	57.01	48.5	44.52	100.81	48.53
Setting Up Orphanage	5.12	16.9	16.8	39.87	12.89	36.5	21.88	27.52	41.24
Special Education	41.43	125.84	165.33	140.01	186.13	196.88	209.24	190.51	305.57
Technology Incubators	4.74	26.34	25.4	16.94	32.1	53.5	62.62	8.57	1.38
Animal Welfare	17.29	66.67	78.71	63.52	98.33	106.12	193.55	168.59	315.98
Vocational Skills	277.07	344.4	379.7	546.46	798.36	1181.23	717.65	1033.84	1164.19
Education	2589.42	4057.45	4534.16	5763.45	6111.66	7179.51	6693.25	6557.13	10085.38
Environmental Sustainability	773.99	796.69	1082.63	1301.96	1368.27	1470.53	1030.16	2432.26	1959.96
Livelihood Enhancement Projects	280.17	393.38	518.49	832.4	907.98	1077.72	938.91	854.48	1654.39
Prime Minister's National Relief Fund	228.18	218.04	158.8	200.42	322.19	798.43	1698.38	1214.84	815.85
Conservation of Natural Resources	44.6	49.85	119.09	228.14	173.55	160.6	92	273.82	580.37
Rural Development Projects	1059.35	1376.16	1572.87	1724.07	2434.17	2301.02	1850.71	1832.82	2005.37
Safe Drinking Water	103.95	180.16	160.12	220.87	228.23	253.4	203.13	182.54	246.36
Slum Area Development	101.14	14.1	51.49	39.16	51.06	42.94	88.95	58.29	93.84
Art and Culture	117.37	119.17	306.13	395.22	225.94	933.57	493.13	248.09	441.02
Socio-Economic Inequalities	39.04	77.97	148.01	155.95	167.92	214.88	149.81	164.85	154.01
Swachh Bharat Kosh	113.86	325.52	184.06	272.07	95.5	53.47	161.35	34.92	55.32
Training to Promote Sports	57.62	140.12	197	285.41	310.16	304	243.39	291.75	526.14

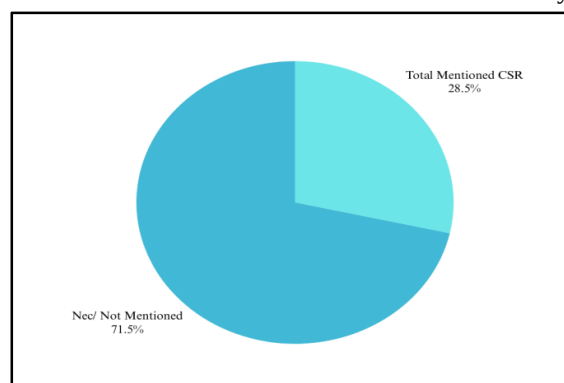
All India PSU vs Non-PSU Contributions (FY 2014-2023)

The Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) spending data for the period FY 2014-2023 reveals significant contributions from both Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) and Non-PSUs in India. Non-PSUs consistently contributed a larger share of the total CSR expenditure, with spending increasing from INR 7,249.11 crores in FY 2014-15 to INR 25,891.15 crores in FY 2022-23. In comparison, PSUs displayed more moderate growth, starting with INR 2,816.82 crores in FY 2014-15 and reaching INR 4,095.78 crores by FY 2022-23. The steady rise in CSR spending from both sectors over the years underscores a growing commitment to community development, reflecting an increasing focus on socio-economic and environmental sustainability.

Table¹⁴

CSR Spending Analysis: Mentioned vs. Not Mentioned Categories (FY 2018-19 to FY 2022-23)

This analysis examines the trends in Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) spending across various districts of Chhattisgarh from FY 2018-19 to FY 2022-23. CSR investments in sectors like education, health, rural development, and livelihood have demonstrated a consistent upward trajectory, growing from ₹42.57 crore in FY 2018-19 to ₹504.4 crore in FY 2022-23. In contrast, the "Nec/Not Mentioned" categories saw fluctuating figures, with a peak in FY 2020-21 at ₹133.25 crore, followed by a decline to ₹90.58 crore by FY 2022-23. The analysis highlights significant growth in well-defined sectors, while spending in undefined areas showed a decrease in the most recent fiscal year.

Table¹⁵

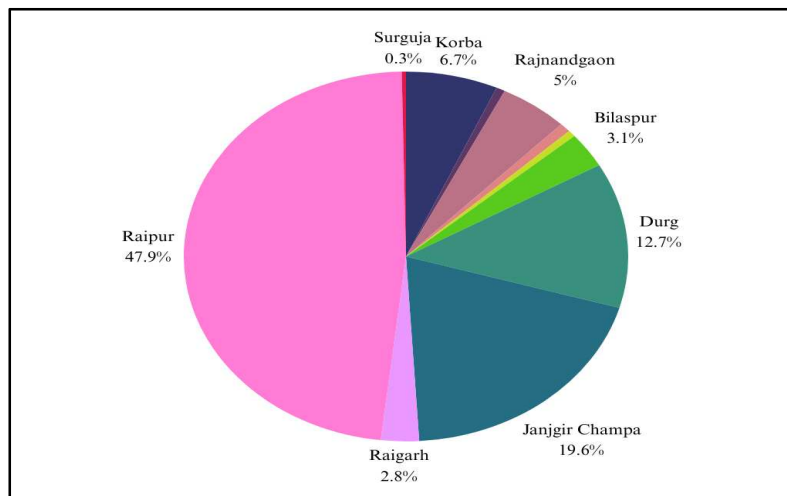
District-wise CSR Spending Distribution in Chhattisgarh

The pie chart illustrates the district-wise distribution of CSR spending in Chhattisgarh, highlighting significant disparities in allocations. Raipur dominates with 47.9% of the total CSR expenditure, reflecting its status as the administrative and industrial hub of the state. Janjgir-Champa

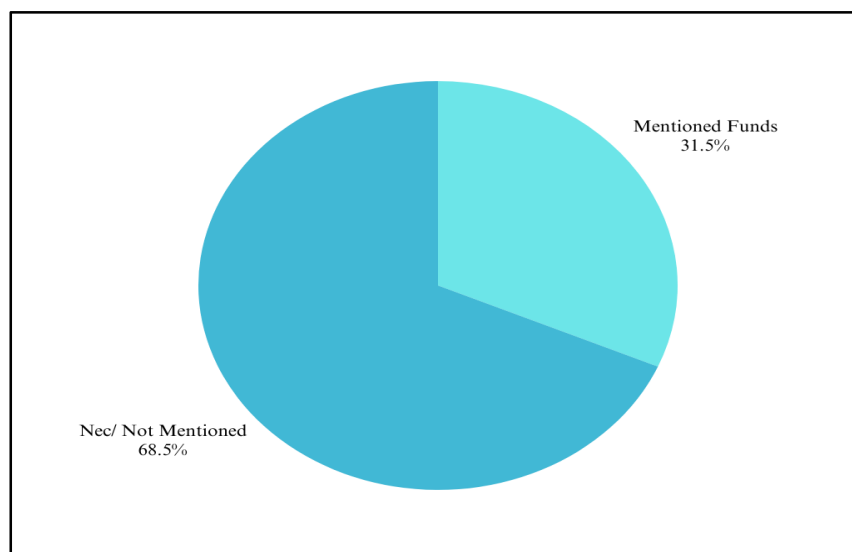
¹⁴Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). National CSR Portal. Government of India. Retrieved from <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>

¹⁵Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). National CSR Portal. Government of India. Retrieved from <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>

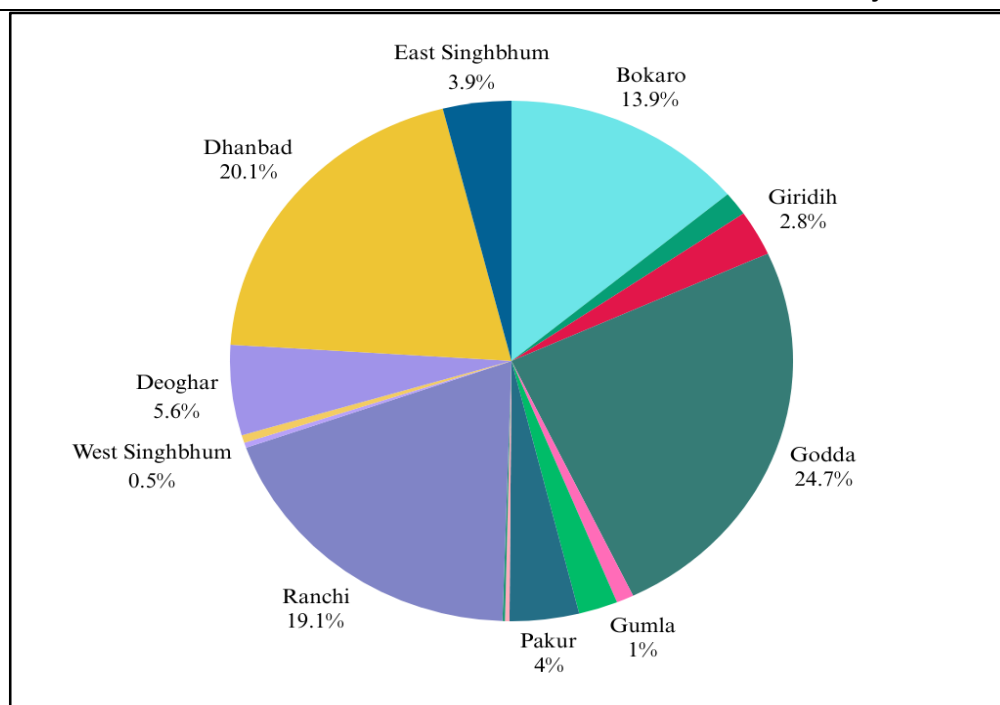
follows at 19.6%, likely due to its strong presence in thermal power and industrial sectors. Durg accounts for 12.7%, showing its importance as a major industrial district. Smaller shares are seen for Rajnandgaon (5%), Korba (6.7%), and Bilaspur (3.1%), despite their industrial and mining activities. Notably, Surguja receives a mere 0.3%, indicating minimal CSR activity, which could be attributed to its remote location and fewer industrial establishments. Raigarh also sees low spending at 2.8%, despite its industrial potential. The chart underscores the need for more balanced CSR spending to ensure equitable regional development.



Table¹⁶



¹⁶Ministry of Corporate Affairs. (n.d.). National CSR Portal. Government of India. Retrieved from <https://www.csr.gov.in/content/csr/global/master/home/home.html>



CSR Spending Trends (2014–2023)

Total CSR Spending

- **Chhattisgarh:** CSR spending in Chhattisgarh has shown a consistent upward trend, increasing from ₹84.85 crore in FY 2016-17 to ₹596.11 crore in FY 2022-23. The state experienced a significant jump in spending between FY 2019-20 (₹269.68 crore) and FY 2020-21 (₹325.63 crore), followed by a sharp rise to ₹596.11 crore in FY 2022-23.
- **Jharkhand:** CSR spending in Jharkhand has also grown steadily but at a slower pace, reaching ₹388.35 crore in FY 2022-23. The state's spending increased notably in FY 2020-21 (₹226.54 crore) and FY 2021-22 (₹193.33 crore), but it remains lower than Chhattisgarh.

Growth Trends

- **Chhattisgarh:** The state's CSR spending growth is attributed to its industrial boom, proactive CSR policies, and higher corporate participation. The Chhattisgarh State CSR Policy (2014) has played a pivotal role in attracting investments.
- **Jharkhand:** Despite its mineral wealth, Jharkhand's CSR spending has been constrained by weaker infrastructure, higher poverty rates, and limited corporate engagement compared to Chhattisgarh.

Spending Fluctuations

- **Chhattisgarh:** A noticeable dip in CSR spending occurred in FY 2016-17 (₹84.85 crore), likely due to economic slowdowns or shifts in corporate priorities.
- **Jharkhand:** Spending remained relatively stable, with modest annual increases, reflecting consistent but slower growth in CSR activities.

Chhattisgarh: State Profile & CSR

Chhattisgarh, created as a separate state in 2000, is one of India's fastest-growing regions in terms of industrial development. The state is rich in natural resources such as coal, iron ore, and bauxite, and has

seen substantial growth in the mining and steel industries. While this industrial boom has created job opportunities, it has also led to challenges such as environmental degradation, income disparity, and inadequate access to essential services like education and healthcare in remote areas.

In recent years, the state government of Chhattisgarh has recognized the role of CSR in addressing these challenges. The Chhattisgarh State CSR Policy, initiated in 2014, encourages companies to invest in social projects that improve the lives of local communities. The state has also adopted a policy of collaboration between government bodies, private companies, and NGOs to ensure that CSR initiatives align with the state's developmental priorities.

Some of the significant sectors benefiting from CSR initiatives in Chhattisgarh include:

1. **Education:** Several CSR initiatives in the state focus on providing educational opportunities, particularly in remote tribal areas. Companies like NTPC, Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL), and Tata Steel have funded educational programs, school infrastructure, and scholarships for students from underprivileged backgrounds.¹⁷
2. **Healthcare:** CSR-driven healthcare initiatives have been critical in improving access to basic health services. For example, NMDC Limited has been involved in providing healthcare facilities in tribal regions through mobile health units and organizing free medical camps.¹⁸
3. **Environmental Sustainability:** Due to the state's heavy dependence on mining, environmental issues have been at the forefront of CSR projects. CSR initiatives focus on forest conservation, water management, and reducing air pollution caused by mining operations. Companies like **Adani Group** have been investing in afforestation and watershed management projects to combat these challenges.¹⁹
4. **Livelihood Improvement:** Numerous CSR programs have been aimed at improving the livelihoods of rural populations. These programs typically focus on skill development, training, and support for local entrepreneurship. For example, Balco (Bharat Aluminum Company) has worked to improve rural livelihoods through its skill development centers, empowering local youth with employable skills.²⁰

Jharkhand: State Profile & CSR

Jharkhand, formed in 2000 from Bihar, is another mineral-rich state located in eastern India. The state is endowed with abundant resources such as coal, iron ore, copper, and mica. However, like Chhattisgarh, it faces significant challenges, including high poverty rates, inadequate healthcare and education infrastructure, and low human development indicators, particularly in rural and tribal areas.

In recent years, Jharkhand has prioritized leveraging CSR as a tool for addressing socio-economic challenges. The Jharkhand State CSR Policy, introduced in 2018, outlines the state's commitment to encouraging CSR investments in sectors such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement. The policy emphasizes the importance of integrating local needs and priorities into CSR projects.

Key sectors where CSR has had a significant impact in **Jharkhand** include:

1. **Education:** Education remains one of the most critical areas for CSR interventions. **Tata Steel**, for example, has played a leading role in developing educational infrastructure, setting up schools, and offering scholarships for marginalized communities in the state.²¹

¹⁷National Thermal Power Corporation (NTPC). (2021). *CSR initiatives in Chhattisgarh: Education and empowerment*. Retrieved from www.ntpc.co.in.

¹⁸National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC). (2020). *CSR in tribal areas: Healthcare initiatives in Chhattisgarh*. Retrieved from www.nmdc.co.in.

¹⁹Adani Group. (2020). *Environmental sustainability in mining regions of Chhattisgarh*. Adani Group. Retrieved from www.adani.com.

²⁰Bharat Aluminum Company (BALCO). (2021). *Empowering rural youth: Skill development through CSR in Chhattisgarh*. Retrieved from www.balcoindia.com.

²¹Tata Steel. (2020). *CSR report: Education and healthcare initiatives in Jharkhand*. Retrieved from www.tatasteel.com.

2. **Healthcare:** As with Chhattisgarh, healthcare is another sector where CSR plays a vital role in improving access to essential services. **Vedanta's Project Aarogya** has been a successful example of CSR communication in Jharkhand. The initiative promotes free health camps, primarily focusing on underserved areas and targeting women and children.²²
3. **Environmental Sustainability:** **Jindal Steel and Power (JSPL)** has been involved in environmental CSR programs in Jharkhand, specifically focusing on reforestation and promoting sustainable agricultural practices. CSR initiatives are also aimed at addressing pollution levels in mining areas and promoting alternative energy sources.²³
4. **Livelihood Improvement:** **Maruti Suzuki** and **Cognizant** have contributed significantly to rural empowerment in **Jharkhand**. These companies' CSR programs aim at promoting local entrepreneurship and improving agricultural productivity through training, financial support, and market access.²⁴

Sectoral Priorities in CSR Spending

Education

- **Chhattisgarh:** Education has been a top priority, with CSR spending increasing from ₹41.43 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹305.57 crore in FY 2022-23. Key initiatives include school infrastructure development, scholarships, and vocational training programs by companies like NTPC and SAIL.
- **Jharkhand:** CSR spending on education grew from ₹8.97 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹150.22 crore in FY 2022-23. Tata Steel has been a major contributor, focusing on building schools and offering scholarships for marginalized communities.

Healthcare

- **Chhattisgarh:** Healthcare spending rose from ₹1847.74 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹6830.41 crore in FY 2022-23. NMDC Limited's mobile health units and free medical camps have been instrumental in improving access to healthcare in tribal areas.
- **Jharkhand:** Healthcare spending increased from ₹40.51 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹119.36 crore in FY 2022-23. Vedanta's Project Aarogya has been a standout initiative, providing free health camps in underserved areas.

Environmental Sustainability

- **Chhattisgarh:** Spending on environmental sustainability grew from ₹773.99 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹1959.96 crore in FY 2022-23. Adani Group's afforestation and watershed management projects have been key contributors.
- **Jharkhand:** Environmental spending increased from ₹8.94 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹52.36 crore in FY 2022-23. Jindal Steel and Power (JSPL) has focused on reforestation and sustainable agricultural practices.

Livelihood Enhancement

- **Chhattisgarh:** Livelihood programs saw spending rise from ₹280.17 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹1654.39 crore in FY 2022-23. Balco's skill development centers have empowered rural youth with employable skills.
- **Jharkhand:** Spending on livelihood enhancement increased from ₹19.04 crore in FY 2014-15 to ₹48.09 crore in FY 2022-23. Maruti Suzuki and Cognizant have promoted rural entrepreneurship through training and financial support.

²²Vedanta Resources. (2023). *Project Aarogya: Health and wellness initiatives in Jharkhand*. Retrieved from www.vedantalimited.com.

²³Jindal Steel & Power Limited. (2021). *Sustainability and environmental CSR initiatives in Jharkhand*. Retrieved from www.jindalsteelpower.com.

²⁴Maruti Suzuki India Limited. (2020). *Rural empowerment and livelihood improvement through CSR in Jharkhand*. Retrieved from www.marutisuzuki.com.

Comparative Analysis of CSR Spending

Total CSR Spending

- Chhattisgarh's total CSR spending in FY 2022-23 (₹596.11 crore) was nearly double that of Jharkhand (₹388.35 crore). This disparity is attributed to Chhattisgarh's industrial growth and stronger CSR policies.

Sectoral Allocation

- **Education:** Chhattisgarh allocated ₹305.57 crore in FY 2022-23, compared to Jharkhand's ₹150.22 crore.
- **Healthcare:** Chhattisgarh spent ₹6830.41 crore, significantly higher than Jharkhand's ₹119.36 crore.
- **Environmental Sustainability:** Chhattisgarh's spending (₹1959.96 crore) far exceeded Jharkhand's (₹52.36 crore).
- **Livelihood Enhancement:** Chhattisgarh allocated ₹1654.39 crore, while Jharkhand spent ₹48.09 crore.

Key Insights

- Chhattisgarh's higher CSR spending reflects its industrial growth and proactive CSR policies.
- Jharkhand's slower growth is due to weaker infrastructure and lower corporate participation.
- Both states prioritize education and healthcare, but Chhattisgarh has a stronger focus on environmental sustainability and livelihood enhancement.

Challenges and Opportunities

Challenges

- **Cultural Barriers:** Tribal populations in both states often face challenges in accessing CSR benefits due to cultural and linguistic differences.
- **Logistical Issues:** Remote and rural areas in both states struggle with inadequate infrastructure, hindering the implementation of CSR projects.
- **Uneven Distribution:** CSR benefits are often concentrated in urban and industrial areas, leaving rural and tribal regions underserved.

Opportunities

- **Strengthening CSR Communication:** Effective communication strategies, including the use of local languages and digital platforms, can enhance community engagement.
- **Stakeholder Collaboration:** Partnerships between government bodies, corporations, and NGOs can improve the alignment of CSR initiatives with local needs.
- **Context-Specific Strategies:** Tailoring CSR projects to address the unique socio-economic and cultural contexts of each state can maximize their impact.

Policy Implications

For Chhattisgarh

- Continue leveraging industrial growth to attract higher CSR investments.
- Focus on equitable distribution of CSR benefits, particularly in tribal and rural areas.
- Strengthen monitoring and evaluation mechanisms to ensure transparency and accountability.

For Jharkhand

- Enhance infrastructure to attract more corporate participation in CSR.
- Develop context-specific CSR policies that address the state's unique challenges, such as high poverty rates and low human development indicators.
- Promote stakeholder collaboration to improve the effectiveness of CSR initiatives.

Conclusion

The analysis of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) spending in Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand from 2014 to 2023 highlights significant regional disparities in corporate engagement, sectoral allocations, and the overall impact of CSR initiatives. Chhattisgarh has consistently attracted higher CSR investments, reflecting a more structured corporate approach to social development, whereas Jharkhand, despite its industrial base, has lagged in CSR fund allocation and implementation. The data indicates that while both states have witnessed growth in CSR contributions, the pace and extent of development vary significantly due to differences in corporate participation, policy support, and infrastructure constraints.

CSR spending trends confirm that Chhattisgarh has seen substantial corporate investments across key sectors such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and livelihood enhancement. The presence of major industries, including NTPC, SAIL, Vedanta, and Jindal Steel and Power Limited, has contributed to a structured approach to CSR, with targeted interventions in rural and tribal communities. The increasing allocation of funds to education and healthcare suggests a corporate focus on long-term societal betterment, particularly in improving literacy rates and medical access in underserved areas. The data also reflects a strong emphasis on environmental sustainability, with corporations investing in afforestation, water conservation, and pollution control initiatives.

In contrast, CSR engagement in Jharkhand has been comparatively lower, despite the presence of major industries such as Tata Steel and Coal India Limited. The state has seen fluctuations in CSR spending, with education and healthcare receiving relatively lower allocations compared to Chhattisgarh. The challenges faced by Jharkhand in optimizing CSR implementation include limited corporate outreach in rural areas, lack of structured state-level CSR policies, and lower transparency in fund utilization. Although corporate initiatives such as Tata Steel's educational programs and NTPC's healthcare interventions have contributed to development, the overall impact remains uneven across the state.

Sectoral analysis indicates that education and healthcare have remained the top priorities for CSR investments in both states, though Chhattisgarh has consistently led in fund allocation. The increase in CSR spending on environmental sustainability, particularly in Chhattisgarh, suggests growing corporate awareness of the ecological impact of industrial activities and the need for sustainable practices. Livelihood enhancement initiatives, while present in both states, have been more pronounced in Chhattisgarh due to targeted skill development programs by corporations such as Balco and NMDC.

The disparities in CSR implementation between Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand underscore the importance of policy interventions and enhanced corporate participation in addressing regional developmental needs. While Chhattisgarh has successfully leveraged CSR as a tool for socio-economic development, Jharkhand requires a more structured approach to ensure that corporate contributions translate into tangible improvements in education, healthcare, and livelihood opportunities. Strengthening CSR governance, improving fund allocation transparency, and fostering collaboration between corporations, state authorities, and local communities can enhance the effectiveness of CSR initiatives in both states.

The findings of this study emphasize the need for a more balanced approach to CSR implementation, ensuring that corporate initiatives align with the specific socio-economic challenges faced by each state. Future research could focus on micro-level impact assessments of CSR projects, stakeholder perspectives on CSR communication, and policy recommendations to enhance corporate engagement in development efforts. As CSR continues to evolve as a critical component of corporate strategy, its role in addressing regional disparities and fostering inclusive growth will remain essential for sustainable development in Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and beyond.

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